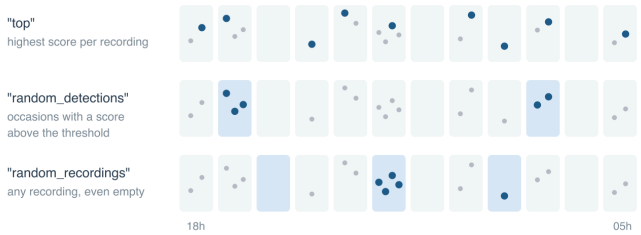
Stage 1: validation data

Choose a design

Each design answers a different question, so a sample drawn for one is not valid for another.



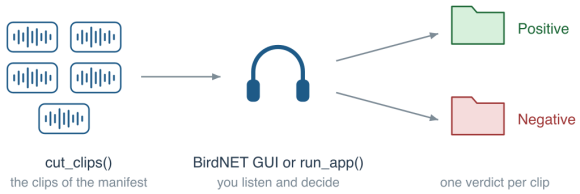
sampling_mode	use
`"top"`	retraining; score-to-probability calibration
`"random_detections"`	false-positive rates; needs `threshold`
`"random_recordings"`	false-positive and false-negative rates

Draw and cut the clips

```
# check the selection first, then cut
extract_validation_clips(data_dir, "validation",
  sampling_mode = "random_detections",
  threshold = 0.5, simulate = TRUE)
extract_validation_clips(data_dir, "validation",
  sampling_mode = "random_detections",
  threshold = 0.5)
```

The clips and `clip_manifest.csv` go to the output folder. To work step by step: `read_selection_tables()`, `select_clips()`, `cut_clips()`.

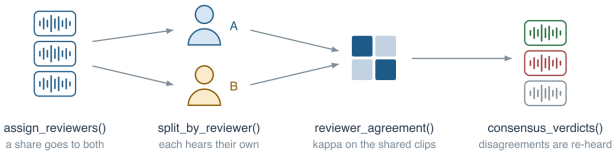
Review




```
run_app("validation/clip_manifest.csv",
  clips_dir = "validation/clips",
  verdicts_file = "validation/verdicts.csv",
  reviewer = "liliana")
```

Or sort the clips in the BirdNET GUI and use `review_dir` below.

Several reviewers



`assign_reviewers()` splits the clips, with a share for both. `reviewer_agreement()` measures their agreement, and `consensus_verdicts()` combines the verdicts.

After the review

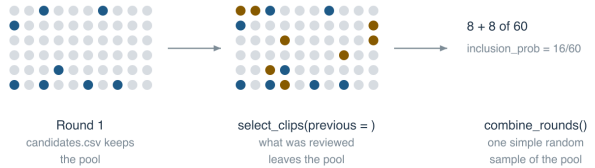
```
post_validation(
  manifest_path = "validation/clip_manifest.csv",
  output_dir = "validation/results",
  verdicts_file = "validation/verdicts.csv")
```

Writes `validation_by_clip.csv`, the precision by bin, the thresholds, the nightly presence and the clips for retraining.

What each label of `review_support()` asks for

label	next step
"reached"	the cell has a threshold
"review more"	another round, below
"not reviewed"	draw clips for the cell
"exhausted"	keep the clips; the model may still give a threshold
"unreliable"	the classifier is the limit: retraining

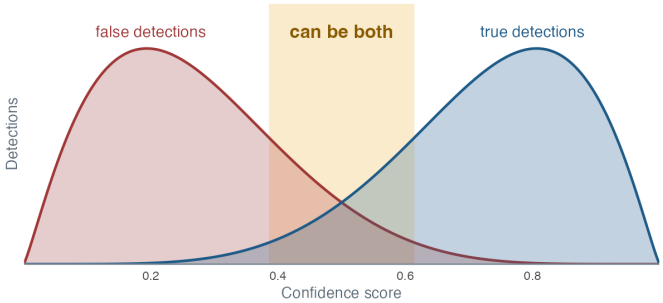
Another round



`select_clips(previous = )` leaves out what was reviewed, and `combine_rounds()` gives every clip its cumulative `inclusion_prob`.

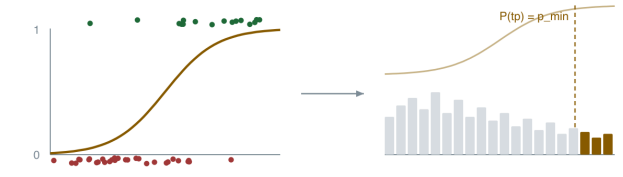
Stage 2: calibration and histories

Why calibrate



A score is not a probability. The scores of true and false detections overlap, and no cut on the score separates them. The curves are illustrative.

From clips to P(tp)




```
res <- calibrate(
  validation_files = val_files,
  prediction_tables = tables,
  output_dir = "calibration", p_min = 0.95)
```

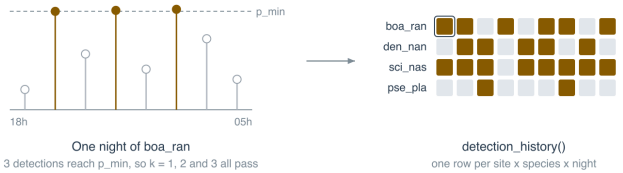
Writes `nightly_detection_history.csv` and `calibration_quality.csv`. Look at `status` before using a species.

Choose a route

route	a detection counts when	uncertainty
A	score ≥ the threshold of the cell	none
B · 1	P(tp) ≥ `p_min`	ignored
B · 2	`pr_reliable` ≥ `prob_min`	used in the cut
B · 3	P(tp) ≥ `p_min` in each draw	propagated

A guarantees the precision of the set kept; B, of each detection, if the curve is right. Ways 2 and 3 need a brms calibration.

From detections to nights



A night counts as detected with at least k detections that count (`min_detections_night`; columns for k = 1, 2 and 3).

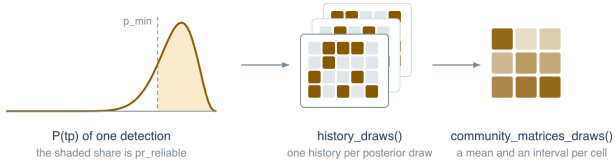
Code per route

```
# A: empirical threshold
val_clips <- read_validation_tables(val_files)
thr_A <- review_support(val_clips, pred,
                        target_precision = 0.90)
history_A <- threshold_history(pred, thr_A)

# B, way 1
history_1 <- res$history

# B, ways 2 and 3, after calibrate(engine = "brms")
history_2 <- detection_history(res_b$scored,
  p_min = 0.95, rule = "probability",
  prob_min = 0.9)
history_3 <- history_draws(res_b$fit, res_b$scored,
  p_min = 0.95, n_draws = 200)
```

One history per draw



Check one route against the other

```
compare_thresholds(val_clips, res$fit,
  scored = res$scored, target_precision = 0.90,
  quality = res$quality)
```

Stage 3 and beyond

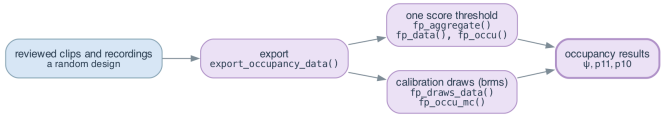
Community matrices




```
status <- cell_status(res$fit,
  read_validations(val_files), p_min = 0.95)
core <- suggest_core_species(status)
mats <- community_matrices(history_1,
                           core_species = core)
mats_3 <- community_matrices_draws(history_3,
                           core_species = core)
```

The final choice of core species is yours. In route A it is manual, as `cell_status()` needs a calibration. `build_community_matrices()` does the same from the history file.

Occupancy with false positives



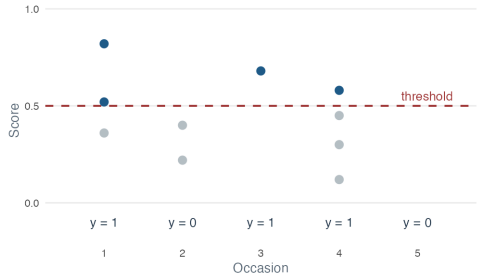

```
export_occupancy_data("occupancy", det,
  recordings = "recordings.csv",
  validation = val_files)
```

Writes every occasion, the scores and the reviewed clips, with their design, for models such as those of crywolf. `fit` adds the posterior draws of a Bayesian calibration.

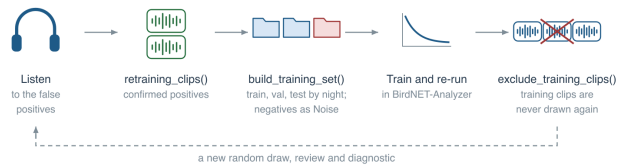
The review must come from `"random_detections"`, which anchors the false-positive rate, and/or `"random_recordings"`, which anchors the state of sites and shows what the classifier misses.

Use a calibration without a site effect: P(tp | score, site) partly reflects how often the species calls at the site, which is what occupancy estimates, so it would be counted twice.

An occasion, from the scores



Retraining

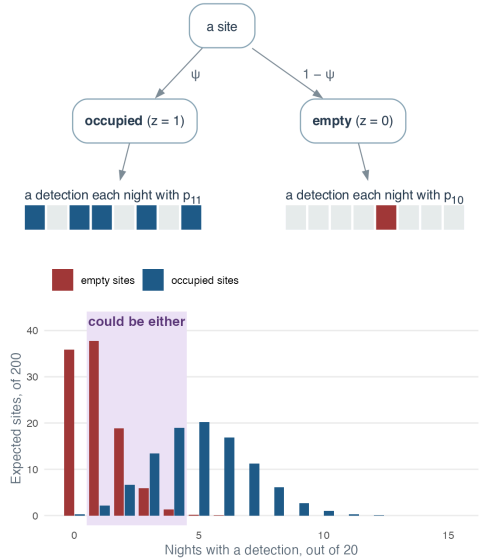


For when the classifier, and not the review, limits precision. `retraining_clips()` lists the positive clips; training itself runs in BirdNET-Analyzer.

```
build_training_set(reviewed, "birdnet_training",
  split = "night", test_prop = 0.2)
```

After retraining, the scores change, so validate and calibrate again.

Two stories for every site



Where the groups overlap, the data alone cannot say how many detections are false: known truth settles that.